

We think that home printers can be slower than the printers in offices. But actually we spend very little time at home and therefore need everything faster when we are at home – be it refrigeration, air-conditioning or printing. Keeping this in mind, consumer products are given fast engines for inkjets.

Coming to the innovation part, what's new?

All new printers look like a beautiful box when switched off. The moment you give power and touch (the printers are touchscreen), the required buttons light up, unlike the keypad or switchboard of regular printers.

We are looking at how we can make the consumer 'wow.' We have launched a new technology called HD DVD print that lets you take print from the HD DVD movie shot by a camera.

Canon has also launched printers with apps for Android and Apple devices. So if I want to take a printout of your photograph from iPhone, I will just click to send the photo right to print from a Wi-Fi printer.

How useful is this HD DVD print technology?

Traditionally, if you want to take a photograph of someone in your home for some special purpose, you look for a professional photographer. You want a good photographer because you don't know which angle to shoot from and how much lighting to use.

That's where the HD DVD print technology helps: If you have a Canon camera, set it in HD mode and then shoot a video of the object by taking a circle around the object. By rotating 360 degrees, you actually get 360 different angles. If you take 20 frames per second, there will be close to 1800 frames, 360 angles in one minute. Just connect the printer, choose the angle at which you or the object looks better and take the print.

What's the focus area right now?

Inkjet printing is home printing. The driving factor this year is HD DVD print. It's a tool for Indian consumers to enjoy photo printing at home.

Today, the number of photos clicked through mobile or cameras is very high. A survey says Indians love images. There are two formats of photographs: One is on print and the other on the screen. In a survey, 40 per cent of people in the age group of 18-25 years love print, while 60 per cent love images on the screen because they can manipulate or zoom in on the screen. As many as 70 per cent in the age

group of 26-35 years love photographs on print because print gives emotion. Touching the photo on print gives you the feeling that you are actually touching the person. That's the reason why photo printing at home is catching on.

What are the common issues that consumers face with inkjets?

Primarily, it's awareness about the operating cost amongst consumers. If the vendor is not educating the consumer about the cost of cartridges, he will be misguided. That's the reason why people really go for refills and all.

The vendor wants to sell a box, not actually a solution. So consumers must ask and understand what is their cost of printing. If you look at quality, you need to pay for it. When you use a genuine cartridge, then only what we commit can be met. Most of the time consumers don't get this input from the dealer. They buy the printer and the next time they go to buy the cartridge they wonder, "Oh my God, this is the cost of cartridges!"

How is it helping you to be present in both camera and printer spaces?

The inventions of digicam and printer are both connected because they protect our photography interest in the market. If you take a photo with a digicam and I am giving a lot of tools to print the photo, it makes a 'wow' factor. A lot of software for photo printing comes with Canon printers by default. It's really helpful when you have the printer and camera of the same brand as they are designed to hand-shake. For instance, Canon camera understands the Canon printer and vice versa.

Your advice to printer buyers?

Keep three questions in mind: What am I going to print – am I going to print a B&W or colour photo, or Web logging, or do I have any specific complicated application? Do I have scanning or copying need also? Do I own a camera or not, or do I plan to buy one within the next six months?

Inkjet is better for colour printing. For copying and scanning even once in a while, it's better to go for an MFP. If you have a digicam, buy a printer that is capable of photo printing. Also look at the capacity of cartridges that the company is offering. Many companies offer cartridges with only 3 or 5 ml. Anything above 8 ml is considered as the optimal capacity. If it's 3 ml, very soon you will have to come back to buy the cartridge. ●

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